

Northgate University

Information Security Policy

Apex policy of the Information Security Management System · Internal Use Only

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Aligned Standard	ISO/IEC 27001:2013 — Clause 5.2 & Annex A.5.1.1

1. Purpose and Policy Statement

Northgate University ("the University") depends on the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of its information to deliver teaching, research, and professional services. This policy sets out the University's overarching commitment to protecting that information and establishes the Information Security Management System (ISMS) through which information security is governed, in line with ISO/IEC 27001:2013.

The University is committed to protecting its information assets against internal, external, deliberate, and accidental threats. This policy is endorsed by the Vice-Chancellor and approved by University Council, and applies to everyone who accesses University information.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all information created, processed, stored, or transmitted by the University in any form; to all information systems and services that the University operates or relies upon; and to all staff, students, contractors, partners, and third parties who access University information. It defines the boundary of the ISMS and sits at the top of the University's information security policy framework.

3. Information Security Objectives

The University's information security objectives are to:

- Protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of University information.
- Manage information security risk to a level consistent with the University's risk appetite.
- Meet all applicable legal, regulatory, and contractual obligations, including the UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018.
- Maintain the availability and resilience of critical information services.
- Ensure information security incidents are identified, reported, and managed effectively.
- Build a culture of information security awareness among staff and students.

4. Leadership Commitment and Principles

University leadership is committed to information security and to the continual improvement of the ISMS, and makes available the resources required to establish, operate, and improve it. The University's approach is governed by the following principles:

- Information security is a leadership responsibility, supported by every member of the University.
- Security controls are selected and prioritised in proportion to assessed risk.
- The ISMS is subject to continual improvement (ISO/IEC 27001:2013 Clause 10).
- Information security requirements are integrated into University processes, projects, and procurement.

5. Governance and Responsibilities

- **University Council.** Holds ultimate accountability for information security and approves this policy.
- **Information Governance Board.** Provides strategic direction, sets the University's risk appetite, and oversees the ISMS.
- **Chief Information Security Officer (CISO).** Owns the ISMS and this policy framework, manages information security day to day, and reports to the Board.
- **Data Protection Officer (DPO).** Oversees compliance with data protection law and advises on the handling of personal data.
- **Information Asset Owners (IAOs).** Are accountable for the security of information assets within their areas of responsibility.
- **All staff, students, contractors, and third parties.** Comply with University information security policies and report incidents promptly.

6. Information Security Policy Framework

This policy is the apex of the University's information security policy framework. It is supported by the subordinate policies and procedures below, each of which provides detailed requirements in a specific area and derives its authority from this policy:

- Information Classification Policy (NGU-POL-8.2)
- Information Security Risk Management Policy (NGU-POL-IRM01)
- Information Security Risk Management Methodology (NGU-POL-4.1)
- Access Control Policy (NGU-POL-9.1)
- Information Security Incident Management Policy (NGU-POL-16.1)
- Supplier Security Policy (NGU-POL-15.1)
- Information Asset Owners Handbook (NGU-POL-8.1)
- Remote Working Policy (NGU-POL-6.2)

7. Legal, Regulatory and Contractual Compliance

The University is committed to meeting all applicable legal, regulatory, and contractual requirements relating to information security and data protection, including the UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018. Compliance obligations are identified, documented, and kept current (ISO/IEC 27001:2013 A.18).

8. Continual Improvement

The University monitors the effectiveness of the ISMS through internal audit, management review, incident analysis, and performance measurement, and acts on the results to continually improve its information security posture (ISO/IEC 27001:2013 Clauses 9 and 10).

9. Compliance and Enforcement

Compliance with this policy and its supporting framework is mandatory for everyone who accesses University information. Breaches may result in disciplinary action in accordance with University procedures and, for third parties, may constitute a breach of contract. Serious breaches may be referred to law enforcement or the relevant regulator.

10. Policy Review

This policy is reviewed at least annually, and following any significant change to the University's operations, risk profile, or legal and regulatory environment. The Chief Information Security Officer is responsible for initiating the review; University Council approves material changes.

11. Document Version History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Change
1.0	01 June 2026	CISO (approved by University Council)	Initial issue. Establishes the University ISMS and information security policy framework.